

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 941

By Travis

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Ola Cecil Harris of Dayton.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly were greatly saddened to learn of the passing of Ola Cecil Harris of Dayton; and

WHEREAS, a highly respected member of the Rhea County Sheriff's Department, Ola Harris was an exemplary public servant and consummate professional who worked assiduously to improve the quality of life for his fellow citizens in numerous capacities; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Harris was born on May 5, 1926, and was a lifelong resident of Dayton, where he made countless contributions to his community; and

WHEREAS, Ola Harris served the Rhea County Sheriff's Office as deputy in the 1950s before being elected as sheriff and serving for three consecutive terms between 1968 and 1974, during which tenure he gained notoriety for busting numerous illegal moonshine operations in his county; he later served as chief deputy under Sheriff Paul Smith; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Harris possessed a strong passion for trucking and worked for Harrison Trucking for sixteen years; he later continued his trucking career with Pero Farms, where he took significant pride in his work as well as the peppers grown on his land; and

WHEREAS, Ola Harris was also deeply devoted to his faith and was a member of The Grove Church; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Harris leaves behind an indelible legacy of integrity and probity in public life, compassion and loyalty in private life, and diligence and dedication in all his chosen endeavors; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should pause to remember the bountiful life of this exceptional public servant and human being; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor the memory of Ola Cecil Harris, reflecting fondly upon his impeccable character, his extraordinary contributions to the people of Tennessee, and his stalwart commitment to living the examined life with courage and conviction.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we express our sympathy and offer our condolences to the family and friends of Mr. Harris.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.